Sherlock
RESEARCH

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Landscaping Industry Report *2026*

Two pages from the full report: one buyer-behavior module and the market forecast, each ending in the recommended move we call the Monday-morning action.

MODULE 03 · BUYER BEHAVIOR

Switching & willingness-to-pay signals

Homeowners who paid for landscaping or lawn care in the last 12 months and were the primary or shared decision-maker. The question: who is loyal, who is shopping, and what would make them leave?

31%
CONSIDERING A SWITCH
Active or soft-switch candidates

52%
QUALITY FIRST
Quality and reliability beat price for the median buyer

57%
20%+ PRICE RISK
Would shop, switch, or stop at a 20% increase

6%
TRUE PRICE BUYERS
Pure cheapest-wins decision makers

What it means

Nearly a third of customers are already open to a new provider, but very few are shopping on price alone. Quality and reliability decide the job for more than half of buyers, while only about one in seventeen is a pure cheapest-wins buyer.

The risk sits in large, sudden increases: more than half would shop, switch, or stop if their price rose 20% or more. Smaller, explained increases on renewals carry far less churn risk than across-the-board jumps.

How to read the segments

- **Quality-first (52%):** protect with reliability guarantees, not discounts.
- **Soft switchers (31%):** win with response time and visible crew consistency.
- **Price-led (6%):** don't build your pricing around them.

MONDAY-MORNING ACTION

Re-price renewals in tiers instead of one flat increase: hold or lightly raise accounts that show switching signals, and apply your full increase to quality-first accounts with a reliability promise attached. Keep any single increase under 20%.

Source: Sherlock 312-person consumer panel of landscaping buyers, last 12 months. Full report adds segment cuts by home value, region, and service line.

MODULE 01 · MARKET SIZE & FORECAST

U.S. landscaping services, 2020–2028

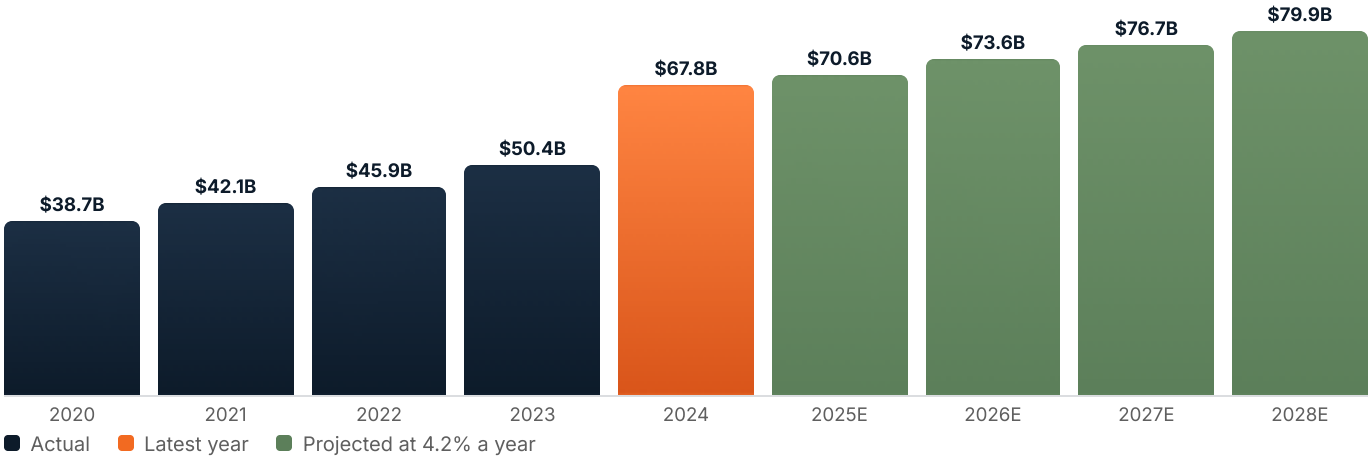
The U.S. landscaping services industry continues to experience strong demand driven by residential investment, commercial development, and an increasing focus on outdoor living.

$67.8B
2024 market size

4.2%
Projected CAGR, 2024–2028

5.1%
Annual industry job growth

62%
Revenue from maintenance



Demand drivers

- **Residential Demand:** Homeowner spending on landscaping and outdoor living remains a top growth driver.
- **Commercial Growth:** Businesses are investing more in curb appeal and sustainable landscaping solutions.
- **Sustainability Trend:** Eco-friendly practices and water-efficient landscaping are in high demand.
- **Labor Challenge:** Finding and retaining skilled labor remains the industry's top challenge.

MONDAY-MORNING ACTION

Growth is steady, not explosive, so share comes from competitors rather than new demand. Put next quarter's sales effort into maintenance contracts, where revenue repeats, and use your labor plan as the cap on how fast you add accounts.

Methodology

Actual years from U.S. Census Bureau and Bureau of Labor Statistics data, cross-checked with Sherlock operator surveys. Projections apply the 2024–2028 CAGR to the 2024 base. Every figure in the full report is labelled with its sample size, data vintage, and coverage.

Get the full 42-page report

Eight modules, each ending in a recommended move. Add a local data cut for any of 22 metros.

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